



Global Referral Policy

Scope

This policy is applicable to all Cognizant Associates in India, NA, LatAm, UK&I, CE & APAC (including Philippines) region. This policy is subject to change from time to time based on business scenarios.

Guiding Principles

Cognizant's Employee Referral Program aims to bring bright talent on board using the trusted network of our own Associates. Cognizant strongly believes that our Associates are our brand ambassadors who attract passionate individuals like themselves capable of sustaining our strong DNA. It is great to see that this has, over time, become the most successful source for new hires at Cognizant.

The Referral policy provides guidelines to recognize and reward Associates for referring suitable candidates to Cognizant.

Glossary

The below table gives the expanded form of the abbreviations used in this document.

PAT	Programmer Analyst Trainee
PT	Programmer Trainee
PE	Process Executive
PA	Programmer Analyst
TL	Team Lead
TM	Team Manager
SA	Senior Associate
SM	Senior Manager
AD	Associate Director
D	Director
SD	Senior Director
AVP	Assistant Vice President
TAG	Talent Acquisition Group
NA	North America
LatAm	Latin America

Key Definitions

Referrer: Cognizant associate referring the potential candidate

Referral: The candidate being referred

Referral bonus: The payment made to the referrer by way of reward

Associate: All employees of Cognizant who are on Full Time/ Fixed Term Full Time/ Part Time (non-contract) employment

Relative: A person related by blood, marriage, or adoption, including parents, siblings, spouses, uncles, aunts, grandparents, first cousins, nieces, and nephews.

Friend: A person who the referrer knows well, but who is not a relative.

Acquaintance: A person who the referrer knows personally, but who is not a relative or a friend. The acquaintance must have been established by the referrer directly (e.g., through seminars, conferences, business visits, etc.)

Related Policy

[Procedure for Anti-Corruption](#)

[Compliance in Recruiting & Hiring Practices](#)

CE	Continental Europe
APAC	Asia Pacific (Excluding India)
UK&I	United Kingdom & Ireland

All associates of Cognizant are eligible to refer potential candidates across the globe. Associates can refer spouse, partner, friends, relatives and acquaintances, including social network connections.

Referral applicability

Globally, across all regions, Associates who have direct responsibility for a requisition's hiring decision, their leadership, and/or any other Associate who has influence, direct or indirect, over the hiring decision for the requisition will not be eligible for a referral bonus. Home and Business Managers who have influence over the referral hire's employment conditions during the [referral bonus payout timeline](#) will also not be eligible for a referral bonus. Region wise applicability for referral bonus is stated below:

India: Director and above are not eligible for referral bonus. Associates in India, at the level of Director and above, will be eligible for referral bonus only while referring candidates who are Director and above. If the referred candidate is a rehire (ex-associate irrespective of level), the candidature will be considered however the referrer will not be entitled for the referral bonus.

North America: Director and above are not eligible for referral bonus. Associates from NA TAG, Campus & Global Executive Recruiting teams are not eligible for referral bonus. If the referred candidate is a rehire (ex-associate irrespective of level), the candidature will be considered, however the referrer will not be entitled for the referral bonus.

APAC: Director and above are not eligible for referral bonus. **Exception:** In Philippines, associate participating in assessment and selection process, senior leadership team (GM and above level), all third-party contract or direct contract workers, full time employees referring a contractual worker can participate in the referral program however will not be eligible for referral bonus.

LatAm: Associates who are at the grade Associate Director level and above are not eligible for referral bonus. If the referred candidate is a rehire (ex-associate irrespective of level), the candidature will be considered however the referrer will not be entitled for the referral bonus.

CE: Associates who are at the grade Assistant Vice President and above are not eligible for referral bonus. Hiring Managers irrespective of the grade will not be eligible. If the referred candidate is a rehire (ex-associate irrespective of level), the candidature will be considered, however the referrer will not be entitled for the referral bonus.

UK&I: Associates who are at the grade Assistant Vice President and above are not eligible for referral bonus. If the referred candidate is a rehire (ex-associate irrespective of level), the candidature will be considered however the referrer will not be entitled for the referral bonus.

Associates who are a part of Global Talent Acquisition Group are not eligible for referral bonus.

All third-party contract or direct contract workers at Cognizant are not eligible for referral bonus

payout.

Full time employees referring a contractual worker will not be eligible for referral bonus.

Referral validity

Each referral will be valid for 180 days, post which it will be considered invalid. The validity period begins from the date of upload onto the referral portal until offer acceptance. Barring an exception, the referral will expire if an offer is not accepted as of the expiration of the validity period. **Exception:** In India, referral profile will be considered valid and eligible for payout if the offer approval date is within 180 days from the date of referral.

During these 180 days, the associate (referrer) can tag the referral candidate against multiple job id and no other associate will be able to refer the same candidate. On expiry of the 180 days, the same candidate may be referred by another associate (except for candidates in offer status).

Referrals must be submitted on the global referral portal and processed by TAG. Referrals submitted directly to hiring managers/clients will not be eligible for bonus. Any other mode of referring candidates will be considered invalid. **Exception:** In Philippines, referrals must be submitted through Employee Referral Program Form (ERP Form) or Referral app and processed by TAG. Referrals submitted directly to hiring managers/clients or any other mode of referring (referral distros, emails, portals, apps) will be accommodated on a case to case basis and will be subject for validation to determine bonus eligibility.

It is a violation of Cognizant's Anti-Corruption Statement to provide preferential treatment in the hiring process for referrals from a client, potential client, or Governmental Official¹ in exchange for any business opportunity or advantage. If a profile is received from or referred by a client, potential client, or Government Official, the Referrer must notify the Talent Acquisition Group in connection with uploading the profile to ensure appropriate diligence is conducted in accordance with Cognizant's "[Procedure for Anti-Corruption Compliance in Recruiting & Hiring Practices](#)". The Talent Acquisition Group will notify the Regional Ethics & Compliance Officer or the Chief Ethics & Compliance Office of the referral.

¹ "Government Official" is any individual acting in an official capacity for or on behalf of a Government Entity²

² "Government Entity" refers to any:

- Government or government division.
- Department, agency, or instrumentality of such a government or organization.
- Political party; or
- Company or entity owned or controlled (partially or wholly) by or acting on behalf of any of the above.

Visit our [Be.Cognizant](#) page for a list of Cognizant clients that have been identified as Government Entities.

A Relative means a person related by blood, marriage, or adoption, including parents, siblings,

spouses, uncles, aunts, grandparents, first cousins, nieces, and nephews.

Policy coverage and applicability

The referral bonus will be paid to the referrer only after the referral completes 90 days of continuous employment with Cognizant from their date of joining. There may be exceptions to this which is detailed in section “Referral Bonus Payout timeline”.

In case the referrer has resigned, the referral bonus will not be paid. Both the referrer and the referral must be active employees, and not serving separation notice period at the time of referral bonus payout. **Exception:** In India, if the referrer has resigned the referral bonus will be paid as part of full and final settlement to the referrer. If the bonus is being processed as part of the final settlement, the referral bonus will be paid to the referrer if the referral has completed a minimum of 60 days of continuous employment with Cognizant from their DOJ and not necessarily 90 days.

The referral bonus will be paid along with the salary subject to withholdings and deductions as required by the applicable law. The details on the referral bonus amount are stated in Appendix A Table 1.

All referrals joining Cognizant will undergo the mandatory Background Verification (BGV) process. Referrals must have cleared the BGV positively but shall be waived if results are not available 3 months after joining date.

Referral Bonus Payout timeline

India, APAC, UK&I, LatAm and CE: Referral bonus payout shall be processed and paid out in the subsequent payroll on completion of 90 days of employment from the DOJ.

1) In El Salvador referral payout will be processed in the next payroll cycle after referral has successfully completed probation period (30 days) and signed permanent contract **2)** In Philippines the referral bonus shall be disbursed in two installments. The first installment of 50% will be paid on completion of 90 days of employment of referral from Date of Joining (DOJ) and the second installment of 50% will be paid only on completion of 180 days of continuous employment of referral from DOJ. In case the 90th or 180th day of the referral falls within a week of payroll cutoff date; the referral bonus will be released in next payroll cycle.

North America (United States & Canada): The referred candidate is required to complete 3 months (90 days) of continuous full-time, active employment with Cognizant. The referral bonus will be paid on the fourth month. Referral bonuses are administered once a month along with the first paycheck (Exempt employees will be paid on the 15th and Non-Exempt employees will be paid on the first or second paycheck of their payroll cycle). For instance, if the candidate started on May 7th, he or she will complete 3 months of employment with Cognizant on August 7th. The referral bonus will be paid on September 15th for exempt employees and September 13th or 27th for Non-Exempt employees.

If the referral joins outside of the base location of the referrer, terms of payment of both countries will be considered and the least will be paid as bonus. The referral bonus is paid to the active payroll account of the associate. **Exception 1):** For Latin American countries associates can only cash a bonus if their referral is hired to work in the same country. They can still refer for other locations but won't be eligible for cashing a bonus if candidate is hired. **2)** In Philippines, associates are entitled for a bonus if their referral is hired to work in the same country. They can

still refer for other locations but would not be eligible for a bonus if candidate is hired.

There are no limits to the number of referrals an associate can make. **Exception: 1)** Associates in India are not eligible for payments above INR 3 Lakhs per year. **2)** Associates in North America and Japan can refer and receive bonuses for up to 5 hires per calendar year. Hires above this limit will still be considered but will be subject to the approval of Regional TAG head.

Candidates hired through campus/off-campus programs are not eligible for referral bonus. **Exception: 1)** In India, referrals to hire graduates are eligible for bonus (applicable only for off campus hiring for CDO). The bonus for such referrals shall be based on the grade of hire as stated in Appendix A Table 1. **2)** In APAC referrals to hire college graduates are eligible for bonus applicable as per advertised opportunity. The bonus for such referrals shall be based on the grade of hire as stated in Appendix A Table 1. **3)** In CE referrals to hire college graduates are eligible for bonus applicable as per advertised opportunity. The bonus for such referrals shall be based on the country of hire as stated in Appendix A Table 2 and not on basis of the grade.

Region specific special referral campaigns and payouts need to be approved by the Regional TAG Head. The modes and means/rules of payout shall be detailed in the campaigns and such provisions will be strictly adhered.

The referral app is designed in a way wherein Associates in APAC, CE, India and UK&I region can upload a candidate profile, without tagging it to a specific job ID. The candidate referred can search opportunities and apply for jobs thereafter. Associates in NA & LATAM region can upload a candidate profile against a specific job ID only.

The way the referral source is tracked varies across regions. In some regions the candidate source (the first associate who uploaded the candidate profile) is given credit, whereas in others, it is the job specific source (the associate who uploaded the candidate profile against the job which the candidate has been hired against) is eligible for the referral bonus. Employee referral bonus payout may not be applicable if the candidate has been referred by any other source, such as agency. Region-wise nuances are explained below.

North America & LATAM: Referral submission will be against specific job id.

APAC, CE, India, & UK&I: Referral submission can be a “Quick Reference” (generic upload) or specific against a job id.

However, the referral bonus shall be paid to the referral source if the candidate is offered within the referral validity as stated in section “Referral Validity”.

Process

1. Login to the global referral application on [OneCognizant](#).
2. The users will have to read and acquaint themselves with the terms & conditions of the referral policy, privacy note and acknowledge the same.
3. Referrer to ensure that they have received consent from the candidate before sharing his/her personal information.
4. The referrer may either upload the profile as generic referral (wherever allowed) or browse

- pen positions in their respective region and tag the profile against a specific job id.
5. Click on 'refer' button to refer someone against the job.
6. Fill in candidate information form and click 'submit'.
7. Track referral progress from the 'activity dashboard'.
8. Technical support with regard to referral app shall be supported via GSD. The referrer is required to type 'Global employee referral program' and raise ticket through OneCognizant.
9. For queries on "Employee Referrals" associate may write to below emails in their respective region.

Region	Email address
APAC	TAGAustralia@cognizant.com
	TAGHK@cognizant.com
	TAGJapan@cognizant.com
	TAGMalaysia@cognizant.com
	TAGME@cognizant.com
	TAGSingapore2@cognizant.com
	CDC-TA@cognizant.com
	ReferralsPH@cognizant.com / ReferralsPH2@cognizant.com
CE	COGNIZANTCEREFERRAL@cognizant.com
India	GSD under category "Employee Referral for India"
Latin America	CareersLatmSupport@cognizant.com
North America	CognizantNAERP@cognizant.com
UK&I	RecruitmentUKIOps@cognizant.com

Exception Management

Cognizant reserves the sole right to determine, in accordance with Cognizant's standard hiring practices, if a referred candidate qualifies for employment by Cognizant. Cognizant may modify or discontinue this program at any time, with or without notice. Should the program be discontinued, any in-process referrals will be handled on a case-by-case basis.

In the event that the same candidate is referred to Cognizant by more than one source; for example, by two Associates or by a Cognizant Associate and a Recruiting Agency, Cognizant at its sole discretion, shall make a judgment regarding the relevant source of the referral.

Any exceptions in the process or terms of the process need to be approved by Regional TAG Head and by Global Hiring Compliance.

Disciplinary Consequences

Subject to local laws and regulations, a violation of this policy could result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination. If you are aware of a violation of this policy, you have an obligation to report it to the Company. As stated in Cognizant's [Whistleblower and Non-Retaliation Policy](#), Cognizant does not tolerate retaliation against any individual who submits a good faith report of a violation or possible violation of law, the Code of Ethics, or other Cognizant policies.

To report a possible violation of this policy, visit Cognizant's Compliance Helpline (a secure and confidential reporting system) at: www.cognizant.com/compliance-helpline.

Policy Modifications

Cognizant reserves the right to amend its policies as necessary. Any changes to the Global Referral Policy will be approved by TAG leadership in consultation with Global Hiring Compliance team.

Version History

Revision Date	Description of Change
MAY-25-2021	Change in the referral bonus for Canada region
DEC-27-2021	Updated link to "Procedure for Anti-Corruption Compliance in Recruiting & Hiring Practices". Referral validity days calculated from referral date instead of profile creation date. Updated contact mail ID for Mexico Philippines included as part of referral policy. Eligibility for referral bonus payout updated for LATAM. Referral bonus payout timeline updated for Argentina. Referral bonus updated for Argentina, Brazil and Mexico.
JUL-04-2023	Grade wise referral bonus amount added for Bulgaria and Italy effective 01-JAN-2023.
MAY-08-2024	Globally applicable provision added to the Referral applicability section to address conflicts of interest.

Policy Control Information

Policy Name: Global Referral Policy

Revision Date: MAY-08-2024

Policy Owner: Chief People Officer

Department: Talent Acquisition Group

Effective Date: MAR-08-2017

Appendix A

Table 1: Grade wise referral bonus

Grade Country	PAT/P	PA	Associate/TL	Senior Associate/ TM	Manager/SDM	Senior Manager/ DGM	Associate Director/GM	Director/ Senior Director	Assistant Vice President & Above
India*	-	INR 5000	INR 12500	INR 30000	INR 40000	INR 50000	INR 50000	INR 100000	INR 150000
North America	USD 750	USD 1000	USD 2000	USD 2000	USD 3000	USD 3000	USD 4000	USD 4000	USD 5000
Australia	AUD 1000	AUD 1000	AUD 1500	AUD 1750	AUD 2000	AUD 2500	AUD 2500	AUD 2500	AUD 2500
New Zealand	NZD 1000	NZD 1000	NZD 1500	NZD 1750	NZD 2000	NZD 2500	NZD 2500	NZD 2500	NZD 2500
China	RMB 3000	RMB 3000	RMB 3000	RMB 5000	RMB 5000	RMB 5000	RMB 5000	RMB 5000	RMB 5000
Japan	¥100000	¥100000	¥ 150000	¥ 175000	¥ 200000	¥ 250000	¥ 250000	¥ 250000	¥ 250000
UAE	AED 1500	AED 1500	AED 2000	AED 2500	AED 3000	AED 3000	AED 3000	AED 3000	AED 3000
Saudi Arabia	SAR 1500	SAR 1500	SAR 2000	SAR 2500	SAR 3000	SAR 3500	SAR 3500	SAR 3500	SAR 3500
Hong Kong	HKD 5750	HKD 5750	HKD 8500	HKD 9750	HKD 12000	HKD 12000	HKD 13500	HKD 13500	HKD 13500
Malaysia	MYR 1250	MYR 1250	MYR 1750	MYR 2500	MYR 2750	MYR 3500	MYR 3500	MYR 3500	MYR 3500
Singapore	SGD 1000	SGD 1000	SGD 1500	SGD 1750	SGD 2000	SGD 2250	SGD 2250	SGD 2250	SGD 2250
Thailand	THB 16000	THB 16000	THB 22000	THB 29000	THB 30000	THB 34000	THB 34000	THB 34000	THB 34000
UK & Jersey**	£ 500	£ 500	£ 750	£ 1500	£ 1500	£ 2500	£ 3500	£ 4500	£ 4500
Ireland*	€ 600	€ 600	€ 870	€ 1,750	€ 1,750	€ 3,000	€ 4,000	€ 5,000	€ 5,000
Netherlands, Belgium, France, Spain, Finland, Austria, Slovakia, Portugal & Germany	€ 600	€ 600	€ 870	€ 1,750	€ 1,750	€ 3,000	€ 4,000	€ 5,000	€ 5,000
Switzerland	CHF 740	CHF 740	CHF 1106	CHF 2200	CHF 2200	CHF 3700	CHF 5200	CHF 6700	CHF 6700
Denmark	DKK 4300	DKK 4300	DKK 6500	DKK 12900	DKK 12900	DKK 21500	DKK 30000	DKK 38600	DKK 38600
Sweden	SEK 5200	SEK 5200	SEK 7750	SEK 15500	SEK 15500	SEK 25800	SEK 36100	SEK 46400	SEK 46400
Norway	NOK 4600	NOK 4600	NOK 6900	NOK 13700	NOK 13700	NOK 22750	NOK 31900	NOK 41000	NOK 41000
Poland	PLN 2350	PLN 2350	PLN 3500	PLN 7000	PLN 7000	PLN 11500	PLN 16250	PLN 21000	PLN 21000
Hungary	HUF 200000	HUF 200000	HUF 300000	HUF 500000	HUF 500000	HUF 800000	HUF 800000	HUF 800000	HUF 800000
Czech Republic	CZK 20000	CZK 20000	CZK 28900	CZK 55600	CZK 55600	CZK 77800	CZK 77800	CZK 77800	CZK 77800
Lithuania	€ 387	€ 773	€ 1,121	€ 2,256	€ 2,256	€ 3,867	€ 5,156	€ 6,445	€ 6,445
Latvia	€ 300	€ 600	€ 870	€ 1,750	€ 1,750	€ 3,000	€ 4,000	€ 5,000	€ 5,000
Italy	€ 600	€ 600	€ 900	€ 1,750	€ 2,000	€ 2,500	€ 3,000	€ 4,000	€ 5,000
Bulgaria	BGN 900	BGN 900	BGN 1750	BGN 2500	BGN 3000	BGN 3500	BGN 4500	BGN 5500	BGN 6000
Morocco	-	MAD 4950	MAD 7180	MAD 14450	MAD 14450	MAD 24750	MAD 33000	MAD 41250	MAD 41250
Kenya	-	30000 KES	40000 KES	93000 KES	155000 KES	320000 KES	320000 KES	320000 KES	320000 KES
Argentina	\$30,000	\$30,000	\$60,000	\$60,000	\$90,000	\$90,000	\$90,000	\$90,000	\$90,000
Brazil	\$500	\$500	\$500	R\$1000	R\$1000	R\$1000	R\$1000	R\$1000	R\$1000
Costa Rica ^{***}	\$125000 Colones	\$125000 Colones	\$125000 Colones	\$125000 Colones	\$125000 Colones	\$125000 Colones	\$125000 Colones	\$125000 Colones	\$125000 Colones
Guatemala	GTQ 3800	GTQ 3800	GTQ 3800	GTQ 3800	GTQ 3800	GTQ 3800	GTQ 3800	GTQ 3800	GTQ 3800
El Salvador	US\$100	US\$100	US\$100	US\$100	US\$100	US\$100	US\$100	US\$100	US\$100
Colombia	COP \$297695	COP \$297695	COP \$297695	COP \$297695	COP \$297695	COP \$297695	COP \$297695	COP \$297695	COP \$297695
Chile	252897 CLP	252897 CLP	252897 CLP	252897 CLP	252897 CLP	252897 CLP	252897 CLP	252897 CLP	252897 CLP
Mexico	\$ 20000 MXN	\$ 20000 MXN	\$ 20000 MXN	\$ 20000 MXN	\$ 20000 MXN	\$ 20000 MXN	\$ 20000 MXN	\$ 20000 MXN	\$ 20000 MXN
Philippines	10000 PHP	10000 PHP	15000PHP	15000PHP	20000PHP	20000PHP	20000PHP	20000PHP	20000PHP
*In India referrals hired as PE/SME for CDO shall be entitled for a bonus for INR 5000 **In UKI referrals for grade PAT/P/PA/PE/SME for FTC roles less than 6 months shall not be liable for referral bonus ***All referrals for positions in IT and all Manager & above position in BPO in Costa Rica are entitled for bonus of \$125,000 Colones. Referrals for regular BPO positions shall be entitled for bonus of \$50,000 Colones alone									

Table 2: Country wise referral bonus for graduate hires in CE region

Country of hire	Referral Bonus
Netherlands, Belgium, France, Spain, Finland, Austria, Slovakia, Lithuania, Portugal & Germany	€ 600
Switzerland	CHF 675
Denmark	DKK 4475
Sweden	SEK 6300
Norway	NOK 5775
Poland	PLN 2500
Hungary	HUF 193000
Czech Republic	CZK 15400

